PART EIGHT: INTERPRETING THE TWELVE TOPICS OF LIFE 821

77. PLACING THE PLANETS IN THE HOUSES 825
Guidelines

78. THE NATURE AND CONDITION OF THE HOUSE 829
Angularity, Favorability, Witnessing

Step One: The Condition of the House 829
Exercise 40: Evaluating the Condition of a House 835

79. DELINEATING A PLANET IN A HOUSE 841

Step Two: The Condition of the Planet 841
Exercise 41: Delineating a Planet with its Condition in a House 849

80. PLANETS AND HOUSE RULERSHIPS 855

Step Three: Integrating Planetary Rulerships 855
Exercise 42: A Planet's House Rulerships 862

81. THE PLANET'S DOMICILE LORD 867

Step Four: The Condition and Location of the Domicile Lord 867
Exercise 43: A Planet's Assistance from its Domicile Lord 873

82. THE OUTCOME OF HOUSE TOPICS 879
Introduction

Delineation Guidelines after Jean-Baptiste Morin (Morinus) 880
Benefic and Malefic Planets, Conditions, and Houses 881
The Fortunate Houses 884
The Unfortunate Houses 885

83. THE DELINEATION OF HOUSE TOPICS 887

Step Five: House Outcomes 887
Single Planet in a House 888
Multiple Planets in One House 891

The Seven Hermetic Lots 992
Cultural Context of the Lot of Fortune 995
The Giver of Fortune and Prosperity 996
Analyzing Fortune 998
Fortune Houses 999
The Lord of Fortune 1000
Exercise 48: The Lot of Fortune and the Domicile Lord of Fortune 1007

89. THE TRIPLICITY LORDS OF THE SECT LIGHT 1011
Bestowers of Happiness, Prosperity, Substance, and Eminence

Triplicity Lords 1014
Identifying the Triplicity Lords of the Sect Light 1014
Analyzing the Triplicity Lords 1016
Angularity 1016
Sign Rulerships 1019
Witnessing by Benefics and Malefics 1021
Other Factors 1021
Comparing the Two Triplicity Lords 1022
Timing with Triplicity Lords 1024
Summary 1025
Exercise 49: Triplicity Lords of the Sect Light 1030

90. THE ULTIMATE RULERS OF THE CHART 1035
The Predominator, the Master of the Nativity, and the Lord of the Nativity

91. THE PREDOMINATOR 1039
(Epikratētōr)

The Predominator According to Antiochus and Porphyry 1040
Outline of the Procedure According to Antiochus and Porphyry 1043
Exercise 50: Identifying the Predominator—Porphyry's Method 1046

92. VARIATIONS IN THE SEARCH FOR THE PREDOMINATOR 1049

Dorotheus and the Predominator 1050
Valens and the Predominator 1052
Ptolemy and the Predominator 1055
Paulus and the Predominator 1056
Summary 1057

Exercise 51: Identifying the Predominator—Alternative Procedure 1063

93. THE MASTER OF THE NATIVITY 1065
(Oikodespotēs)

Identifying the *Oikodespotēs* 1066
The Global Role of the *Oikodespotēs* 1069
Evaluating the *Oikodespotēs* 1072
Exercise 52: Determine the Master and Joint-Master of the Nativity 1082

94. THE LORD OF THE NATIVITY 1085
(Kurios)

Procedure for Determining the *Kurios* 1090
Exercise 53: The Lord of the Nativity 1107

95. THE FIVE RULERS OF THE NATIVITY 1113
Final Summary

Exercise 54: Final Summary of the Rulers of the Nativity 1120

96. LENGTH OF LIFE 1123
An Overview of Timing Methods

Primary Directions 1124
The Ascensional Times of the Signs 1127
Planetary Periods 1130
Circumambulations through the Bounds 1132
The Horimæa 1135

97. LENGTH OF LIFE 1137
An Overview of Procedures

The Predominator as Releaser (*Aphetēs*) 1137
The Master of the Nativity 1138
The Killing Planet (*Anairetēs*) 1139
The Procedures 1140

98. SOURCE READINGS FOR THE RULERS OF THE NATIVITY 1147

Primary Source Readings for Part Nine: The Rulers of the Nativity 1147

CHAPTER 62

Classifications

OF THE HOUSES

HOUSES CAN BE CLASSIFIED IN VARIOUS WAYS ACCORDING TO THEIR relative strength, favorability, and the chronological ages of life. Each of these categories, as well as significations from the derived houses and the planetary joys of the houses, contribute to the composite meaning of each house.

The word that the Hellenistic astrologers used to describe the underlying condition of a house was the verb *chrēmatizō*. The primary meaning of this word is "to transact business for one's own profit"—or in a more colloquial sense, "to make money". In this sense, the term is often related to the successful management of a household or property, which the Greeks called *oikonomia* (the origin of our modern word, "economy"). Economy derives from *oikos*, "house" and *nomos* "law"; the same sense is implied in Hellenistic astrological texts when they speak of the domicile or estate that a certain planet rules. The desire for profitability was therefore closely related to the idea of advantageous houses. As the Greek philosopher Xenophon wrote in an essay on estate management (*Oikonomia*): "what is profitable is wealth, and what is harmful is not wealth".[1]

A major tenet of valuable real estate is "Location, location, location". This idea seems to be behind the notion that some houses are considered more effective locations than others for doing profitable business and are thus more positively valued. In an astrological context, however, it is the business of the native's life. A planet's house location influences the circumstances that dispose the planet's "business"—its activities and associated topics—to eventuate in ways that are effective and profitable, or ineffective and unprofitable.

In addition to profitable business dealings, the word *chrēmatistikos* was also associated by the Greek populace with oracles. A less common meaning of *chrēmatizō* is: "to give a response to those who consult an oracle". The most famous oracle in the ancient world was at Delphi. On the occasion of the Pythian Games (held every four years, similar to the Olympic Games), city-state

1 XENOPHON, *Oikonomia* 1.10 (fourth century BCE).

Hermon in Israel, is buttressed against a large cliff known as the "Rock of the Gods". From the mouth of a cave at the base of this cliff, a stream flowed that was thought to emerge from the underworld. When Jesus brought his disciples to this site, which contained shrines to Pan and the nymphs, it was considered a pagan, degenerate place. He proclaimed: "You are Peter, and on this rock, I will build my church, and the gates of Hadēs will not overcome it".[2]

FOLLOW THE MONEY

Hadēs was the abode of Pluto, and among other attributions, Pluto was the god of wealth. Jesus was outraged by the temple priests who allowed the money changers and lenders to facilitate a brisk trade in the sacred precincts that exploited the poor in their purchase of sacrificial animals as offerings for the rituals. Jesus' intention was that his church remain uncorrupted by the immoral financial practices that were associated with the pagan god of wealth who resided in Hadēs. From this perspective we can see how the adage, "money is the root of all evil", casts the shadow of unfavorability onto the second house.

However, the underworld of Hadēs (Pluto) is also the source of hidden wealth beneath the earth. Ancient Greek iconography depicts Ploutos, a young child of Dēmētēr (the goddess of agriculture), holding a cornucopia of vegetative bounty arising from under the earth. Echoing some of the fourth-house significations, it is from Pluto's domain that the yearly renewal of crops emerges into the upper world together with oil, gemstones, gold, and other precious metals. In this way, we can see how the riches of Hadēs are easily transposed into the money generated from one's livelihood.

The main Greek word used for second-house significations is *bios*, which, like *zōē*, means "life", but in this context it refers to one's manner of livelihood, i.e., the means of making a living. One of the fundamental issues of human survival is how a person gains the necessary resources to support and sustain physical existence: a roof over one's head, food on the table, money in the bank. The second house points to the factors involved in generating, maintaining, and substantiating one's lifestyle.

Poverty is one of the unfortunate outcomes of the second house. Lack of money can lead to misery through paucity of fundamental necessities, such as adequate shelter, sufficient food, access to medical care, and educational opportunities—not only for oneself, but also for one's family and dependents.

2 Matthew 16:18.

paternal circumstances into which a person is born, whereby the father establishes the child's position in society, provides the resources for growth and education, and guarantees rights to the paternal legacy and inheritance. In many ways, the *pater familias* (father of the family) is the paradigm for the astrological *oikodespotēs* (master of the household), the planet that rules a domicile.

There is much confusion in the astrological traditions as to which parent, the father or mother, belongs to which house, the fourth or tenth. Many Arabic and Medieval authors cite the tenth house as the place of the mother. Most of the Hellenistic authors assign both parents to the fourth house, yet emphasize the father as the primary parent. Ptolemy was the only Hellenistic astrologer who was thought to have placed the mother in the tenth house. This is based on a passage on the topic of siblings in which Ptolemy looks to the culminating place of the mother, which he defines as the place of Venus in a day chart or the place of the Moon in a night chart.[2] Thus, one would investigate the tenth house from the Moon or from Venus in order to inquire about siblings born from the same mother. The Arabic astrologer 'Umar al-Tabarī understood this to mean that the culminating tenth place was the house that signified the mother.[3] This attribution was subsequently adopted by Bonatti and other astrologers and henceforth entered into the Medieval and Renaissance traditions.

An argument can be made for this position based upon the premise that each house brings forth not only its own significations, but also the nature of the opposite house.[4] Thus, the tenth house also relates to the parents. In derived houses, the tenth is the seventh from the fourth, hence the spouse of the fourth-house father is the tenth-house mother. In a more specific sense, the tenth house can depict the stepmother (other wives of the father who are not one's own mother). However, as the astrological tradition went on, the issue became more complicated with the overlay of the twelve-letter alphabet system. Modern astrologers associate the fourth house with Cancer, connected to the Moon and the maternal matrix, and the tenth house with Capricorn, connected to Saturn, one of the traditional significators of the father, especially in a night chart. The fourth house can safely be used as the starting place for an analysis of both parents, with additional insights in accordance with each astrologer's approach and training.

Ancient texts included the predecessors of the parents in the list of fourth-house significations. Thus grandparents, all of one's ancestors, and the ancestral legacy as a whole are part of the fourth-house foundation. Based upon the most

2 *Tetrabiblos* 3.5 (Robbins; compare 3.6 Schmidt)
3 'Umar al-Tabarī, *Three Books on Nativities* 3.4.2.
4 Valens, *Anthology* 4.12.

In classical myth, Venus-Aphroditē was born from the sea foam that coalesced around the seminal fluid emitted from the castrated organ of her father, Ouranos. She was worshiped as the goddess of beauty, love, and desire who stimulated the sexual energies so that life could continue to be created. In the Hellenistic astrological texts, the Venusian force in the fifth house was directed towards the reproductive organs where it becomes the means by which children as physical progeny are generated. The benefics in this house were seen as giving good childbirth and notable children, while the malefics became destroyers of children or made them disobedient.[3]

Children were considered a source of good fortune, blessings, and happiness. As the wealth of the father (second from fourth), they were assets to the household, both as workers for the family business or farms as well as security for the old age of the parents. Children promulgated the name and genes of the father and contributed to the immortality of the parents. Children gave verification of virility for men and fertility for women. They also gave a woman social status and protection within the community, as barrenness could be a cause for divorce or displacement by other wives.

The name of the fifth house—Good Fortune (*agathē tuchē*)—is related to the Greek goddess, Tuchē. *Tuchē* is the Greek term for fortune, and in Greek myth, she was a goddess of chance who could capriciously dispense both good and bad fortune. Cities erected statues of her holding a cornucopia in the hopes that she would bestow prosperity upon their locale. Hellenistic astrologers looked at planets in the fifth house, especially the benefics or those in good condition (particularly when they were the rulers of the Ascendant or of the Lot of Fortune) as bringers of good fortune in the form of honors, riches, success, fame, and leadership. The fifth house was also seen as a potential source of donations made by a community as a whole for a common cause or need.

According to the schema of the chronological ages of the houses, the fifth house signifies the things after death. As such, it often refers to the praise or blame that the native receives during their burial rites or eulogies.

While the sexual activities of Venus lead to the procreation of children, the Hellenistic texts did not explicitly associate the fifth house with sensual and sexual pleasures. The range and variety of sexual activities were described by Venus and Mars as planetary significators rather than as a fifth-house topic. However, that would change with the advent of the Arabic tradition.

The primary theme of children was carried forward by Arabic and Medieval astrologers. The authors gave detailed guidelines for natal and horary interpre-

3 PAULUS, *Introduction* 24.

tations concerning the number, sex, character, status, and timing for children and women's pregnancies. In addition, Arabic astrologers also translated the "joy" of Venus as sensual pleasures, which were added to the list of fifth-house significations. It was seen as the house of love (Sahl), delights (al-Andarzaghar, al-Qabīsī), seeking a woman (al-Khaiyāt, Sahl, Abū Ma'shar), and desires and sexual intercourse (Abū Ma'shar). Food, drink, and fine clothing were also added to the bevy of pleasures found in the fifth house.

The Arabic authors considered gifts and emissaries as fifth-house significations. This is because emissaries from other nations—e.g., legates, ambassadors, and embassies—typically came bearing gifts. As such, they were often a source of good fortune. By the end of the Arabic period, many of the texts enumerated that the first triplicity lord of the fifth house signifies children, the second delights, and the third emissaries and legates.

The good fortune of "speculative enterprises", which are now part of the modern corpus of fifth-house significations, did not enter into the tradition until the Medieval period. Writing in Hebrew in the twelfth century, Ibn Ezra repeats all the previous fifth-house significations and then adds *mazal*, which means constellation, but also luck, games of dice, and hence gambling. The Jewish phrase *mazel tov*, which is used to give congratulations, means good luck and is connected to a person's fate or fortune. This is the first mention of games of chance in relation to good fortune and pleasurable pastimes, which have since become embedded into the modern understanding of fifth-house meanings, especially sports and sport-betting. At the beginning of the twentieth century, Alan Leo headed his fifth-house chapter as the "House of Enterprises", which included all speculative endeavors, even in business dealings.[4]

In mid-fifteenth-century Europe, the influence of the planets upon their "human children" was a popular subject depicted in a variety of woodcut block-books which illustrated the various pastimes, professions, and activities associated with each planetary deity. The children of Venus were shown playing musical instruments, singing, dancing, kissing, and wooing. Renaissance astrologer William Lilly includes pleasures, delights, and merriment associated with banquets, ale-houses, taverns, and theaters under fifth-house meanings. By extension, all places of amusement and recreational activities fall into the fifth house.

4 Alan LEO, *The Key to your Own Nativity* (London: Modern Astrology Office, 1910).

incapacitation. However, a sixth-house planet was thought to be rendered more active if it cast a trine ray within three degrees to the exact degree of the Midheaven or to a planet in the tenth house.[4] If a sixth-house planet is in good condition and of the sect, it is capable of suppressing some of the difficulties of the house. A well-placed benefic, for instance, has the potential to transform the misfortune into fortune.

In the traditional techniques of judging illness, the system of *melothesia* assigned zodiacal signs and planets to the various body parts and organs. The sixth-house zodiacal sign pointed to the kinds and sources of diseases and defects that might afflict an individual. The planets located in the house indicated the part of the body that was vulnerable and the type of disease, while the nature and condition of the planets indicated the native's propensity toward illness. The lord of the sixth house was also considered as an originating cause of illness. Sixth-house factors were compared to first-house factors to see which significator was stronger. Would the native's vital force overcome the illness or succumb to it? This sector included accidents and injuries, especially to the feet due to the prevalence of people crippled through accident, surgery, or birth.

There are a number of factors that can mitigate poor health indications, and in some cases point to those who are healers of disease rather than victims. In modern astrology, the power of the first house has been transferred to the sixth, where the sixth house is now called the house of health. Its significations include the health industry and health professionals, the spectrum of healing arts, holistic health protocols, regimens of diet, nutrition, fitness, hygiene, and preventative measures. It is discussed in terms of efficient functioning and self-improvement, where personal health and integration become a prerequisite for successful relationships encountered in the next house, the seventh. However, if you follow this approach, it is important to remember that the essence of the sixth house is fundamentally weakness arising from ill health, and all of these treatments are remedial measures brought about by factors such as benefic planets or the lord of the sixth house in good condition.

Slaves were also a major topic of the sixth house in the traditional literature. Slavery was a common form of misfortune in the ancient world, and could be encountered through warfare, piracy, debt, or birth. In the many wars between the Hellenistic kingdoms, captives were taken as booty by victors. A man could put himself and his family up for collateral for loans, and if unable to pay his debts, all could be taken as slaves. Many previously wealthy and educated people became the property of a master whom they served as domestics, in farming or

4 PAULUS, *Introduction* 27.

CHAPTER 70

The Seventh House

SETTING (DUSIS)

> There remains one region, that in the setting heaven. It speeds the falling sky beneath the Earth and buries the stars. Now it looks forth on the back of the departing Sun, yet it once beheld his face; so wonder not if it is called the portal of somber Pluto and keeps control over the end of life and death's firm bolted door. Here dies even the very light of day, which the ground beneath steals away from the world and locks up captive in the dungeon of night. This temple also claims for itself the guardianship of good faith constancy of heart. Such is the power that dwells in the abode which summons to itself and buries the Sun, thus surrendering that which it has received, and brings the day to its close.—MANILIUS.[1]

THE NAMES OF EACH ANGULAR HOUSE ARE BASED UPON THE LOCATION of the Sun at one of its critical turning points in its daily journey. The first house marks the place where the Sun rises over the horizon in the east and ascends into the daytime sky. The seventh house marks the place where the Sun sets beneath the horizon in the west and descends into the realms of night. Hence, this sector is called Setting (*dusis*) and the western angle. It is a strong and stable place due to its angularity, and a favorable location insofar as it is configured to the Ascendant. However, the adversarial opposition can bring competition and conflict to seventh-house interactions. No planet rejoices in the seventh house.

The symbolism of the western direction in ancient philosophy and myth shapes the meanings of the seventh house. The west, where the Sun sinks beneath the horizon, was seen as the place of decrease and death. In ancient Greek cosmology, the river Oceanus was a great freshwater stream that encircled the flat earth. At the farthest western edge of the cosmos, beyond the dark misty shore, beyond the setting Sun, lay Hadēs, realm of the dead. A tree with the golden apples of immortality grew in the mythical garden of the Hesperides

1 MANILIUS, *Astronomia* 2.948–958.

that was located on the western shores of Oceanus. *Hespereus* in Greek means both "evening" and "the western direction" and is etymologically related to the English word "west". In Egypt, the tombs of dead pharaohs were built on the western banks of the Nile River. Manilius describes how the region of the setting Sun that brought the day to its close was the portal of somber Pluto, who keeps control over the end of life and death's firm-bolted doors.[2]

Death and the final age of life were prevalent meanings for the seventh house in the Hellenistic literature. Traces of these meanings continue to appear through to the Renaissance, but disappear by modern times. Rhetorius conveys that Jupiter makes for a fine old age, free from toil with windfalls from abroad, while Venus makes the native youthful and pleasing in old age; Saturn, if of the sect and in its own domicile or exaltation, can make for long-lived persons who are rich in old age, but distressed in youth.[3]

Marriage is the primary meaning for the seventh sector of human experience throughout the historical tradition. As each house reflects some of the principles of the house that opposes it, the seventh-house spouse forms the complementary opposite of the first-house self (the "life of the native"). Some authors assigned intercourse with the wife or an affair with a woman as seventh-house significations, indicating the tendency for most clients of astrology to be men for whom the seventh-house "other" were women and wives. Firmicus Maternus wrote that the seventh house indicated the quality and quantity of marriages, while Manilius speaks tenderly of the seventh house as "constancy of the heart".[4]

The topic of marriage was discussed extensively by Ptolemy, Valens, Dorotheus, and Firmicus Maternus. In addition to the seventh house and its lord, astrologers looked to the placements of Venus and Mars, and to the Sun for a woman and the Moon for a man, as marriage indicators. Their inquiries focused upon the number of marriages, if they would occur early or late in life, and whether they would be lasting and beneficial. The delineation included the nature and rank of the spouse, whether high or low-born, wealthy or poor, relative to the person's own eminence.

Marriage to a king or prince was indicated if the native had the signature of high eminence and the significator of relationship was in good condition. Middling eminence and a good relationship significator pointed to a fortunate marriage to a prosperous merchant; and low eminence, but a good relationship significator showed a happy marriage to a laborer. For the most part, the condi-

2 MANILIUS, *Astronomica* 2.951–952.

3 RHETORIUS, *Compendium* 57.

4 FIRMICUS, *Mathesis* 2.21.8; MANILIUS, *Astronomica* 2.956.

and regeneration, the death of the old and the birth of new things from the ruins". There are many cross-cultural myths of death and subsequent regeneration. In Egypt, the dead body of Osiris was resurrected long enough for Isis to conceive the child Horus, and each year Osiris, as the god of the Nile, floods and restores the parched land to vegetative life. In Greece, Pluto's underworld bride, Persephonē, returns to the upper world each spring accompanied by all germinating seeds and blooming flowers. Christian scripture tells of Jesus rising from the dead after three days.

The final eighth-house topic that must be addressed is its contemporary identification as the "house of sex". In an exhaustive analysis of astrological texts from the first to the twentieth centuries, the first mention of sexual activity as an explicit signification of this house was a single line by Alan Leo in 1910.[3] He wrote that the eighth house "indicates the sex tendencies" with no further commentary or interpretations.

We might well ask how sex, the force that creates life and is traditionally associated with romance and children (the fifth house) or with intercourse with the spouse (the seventh house), later came to be placed in the eighth house of death. The earliest Hellenistic texts made correspondences between the zodiacal signs and the parts of the body. According to the system of *melothesia*, Scorpio was linked to the sexual organs, euphemistically referred to as the secret places or private parts. In the sixteenth century, Johannes Schoener included the bladder, pubic hair, and the genitals in his list of eighth-house significations[4] and Claude Dariot listed Scorpio as a co-significator of the eighth house along with Saturn.[5] We thus see the following progression: (1) the sexual organs linked to Scorpio; (2) their placement in the eighth house; and (3) the association of the eighth house with Scorpio. From here it was a short leap to Leo's 1910 assertion that the eighth house indicates the sexual tendencies.

There are several backstories that provide further insight into the reasons for this correlation between sex and death. Alan Leo was celibate. As a Theosophist, he traveled to India where he encountered the spiritual practice of withholding ejaculation to avoid decreasing the life force within the body. The interplay between sex and death was also proposed by Sigmund Freud in his speculations on the relationship between Erōs (sex) and Thanatos (death). For Freud, sex formed the root of the abnormal behaviors and psychological disorders that the ancients had long placed in the eighth house. *La petite mort*, "the little death", referring to the post-orgasmic state of unconsciousness, was

3 Alan LEO, *The Key to Your Own Nativity*, chapter 26.
4 SCHOENER, *Opusculum Astrologicum* 2.5.
5 DARIOT, *Introduction to Judgment of the Stars* 1.13.

a popular theme in nineteenth century French literature. The Victorian era was characterized by both sexual repression and widespread promiscuity, resulting in the increase of fatal sexually transmitted diseases. The cultural associations of sex and death found their way into revisions in the astrological literature and foreshadowed the worldwide AIDS epidemic in the later part of the twentieth century. In ancient Greek mythology, another name for the god Hadēs (Latin Pluto) was Aidoneus.

In 1925, Charles Carter wrote that the eighth house was related to the sexual nature; in 1951 Margaret Hone included the sexual act in her discussion of this house; and by the early 1970s, sexuality was commonly accepted as a fundamental meaning of the eighth house by most astrologers.[6] A contemporary internet search now identifies it as the house of sex. The question that must be asked is what kind of sex belongs in the eighth house, if indeed it belongs there at all. Under what circumstances does the force of life reside and act in the house of death?

Contemporary descriptions look to Pluto for rulership of the eighth house and focus upon the motif of transformation and rebirth in order to discuss this sector. Mythological Pluto was Lord of the Dead, but stories rarely depict him as leaving his realm of Hadēs. He raged when anyone tried to reclaim a soul back into the world of the living. The pivotal story in his mythical biography is his rape and abduction of the maiden Persephonē, who then became the Queen of the Underworld and guardian of the souls of the dead. However, due to the bargaining of her mother, Dēmētēr (Ceres), Persephonē was allowed to rise from the world of the dead each spring in order to renew vegetative life. Dēmētēr and Persephonē were the central figures of the Eleusinian Mysteries, and it was the sexual act in the sacred marriage between Persephonē and Zeus that gave birth to the holy child. The great revelation included the Queen of the Dead giving birth to new life, manifesting in the physical world as the quickening and germination of all dormant seeds, bringing another season of fertility to the land. Persephonē is thus a much more appropriate archetypal symbol than Pluto for the transformative potentials of the eighth house.

The connections between death, sexual union, and rebirth are also present in the mystery teachings of other ancient cultures. Tibetan Buddhist beliefs, for instance, suggest that during the journey through the *bardo* of death, the soul is pulled toward reincarnation through the womb of its future mother upon being magnetized to one of the parents during the act of sexual intercourse.

6 HONE, *The Modern Textbook of Astrology* (London: L.N. Fowler & Co., 1950).

from his golden helmet".[2] Apollō, the great Olympian god of light who was conflated with Hēlios, was worshiped as the god of divination, healing, music, and the arts. In all his guises, the Sun god illuminates the world with his light and observes everything that passed beneath him as he transverses the skies each day. Vettius Valens describes the astrological Sun as the "light of the mind, the organ of perception of the soul, and the kingly office".[3]

In the ancient literature, God was envisioned as a *dēmiurgos* (demiurge), a "maker" or "creator", as well as a *kosmokrator*, a "ruler of the world". His oversight of the ninth house signifies that his sector represents the larger world and the larger mind. It provides the experiences that take us to the edge of the known, broadening our perspective and facilitating our search for larger meaning, wisdom, and understanding. These experiences include travel to far-distant and foreign places, religion, pilgrimage, divination, higher education, and making judgments in accordance with the spirit of the law where our ethical values can be actualized into practice. For the most part, these topics have remained consistent through the historical tradition. We will look at some of the rationales, details, and subtleties given by ancient authors, as well as the ways these topics take shape in contemporary culture.

From the perspective of Earth, the annual course of the Sun determines the solar year, whereas the Moon's shorter orbital period determines the month. The ninth house is the sector signifying long-distance travel as contrasted with the third-house signification of short-distance travel. In the ancient world, people did not generally travel long distances for pleasure or vacation as they do today. Being away from home was regarded as an affliction because it entailed uncertainty, hardships, and dangers from storms, shipwrecks, robbers, or disease. The main reasons that a person might travel would be for business, trade, diplomacy, study with foreign teachers, pilgrimage to the cult oracle of a god, or to make an offering as remediation for a god-sent illness.

A selection of ninth-house horary questions from Medieval and Renaissance astrological texts written by Sahl, Bonatti, and Lilly reveal that people were concerned about whether or not travel would take place, the purpose and usefulness of the journey, the ease or difficulties encountered entering a foreign city, and the probability of a safe return. The sign of the ninth house, its lord, Lot, as well as any planets in the house, especially Mars, were all analyzed for the judgment and outcome. Various Hellenistic authors looked to the ninth house for indications of travel abroad, its direction, and frequency. They sought to as-

2 *Homeric Hymn* 31, trans. EVELYN-WHITE.
3 VALENS, *Anthology* 1.1.

CHAPTER 73

The Tenth House

MIDHEAVEN (MESOURANĒMA)

> First place goes to the cardinal which holds sway at the summit of the sky and divides the heaven in two with imperceptible meridians; enthroned on high this post is occupied by Glory (truly a fit warden for heaven's supreme station), so that she may claim all that is preeminent, arrogate all distinction, and reign by awarding honors of every kind. Hence comes applause, splendor, and every form of popular favor; hence the power to dispense justice in the courts, to bring the world under the rule of law, to make alliances with foreign nations on one's own terms, and to win fame relative to one's station.—MANILIUS.[1]

THE TENTH HOUSE RECEIVES THE NAME MIDHEAVEN BECAUSE IT SPANS the middle of the heavens where the Sun gains its highest elevation and reaches its peak above the earth. It was considered the second-best of all the houses: of strong dynamic angularity with stable support and fortunately configured to the Ascendant's life force by the powerful superior square. In the chronological scheme of the houses, it represents middle age, when a person has come into the summit of their power and position in the world.

The exalted symbolism of the tenth house was reflected by its position in the *thema mundi*, the famous historical chart depicting the creation of the world. As discussed in chapter 12, this chart has Cancer rising and Aries culminating at the Midheaven. The ancient Hermetic scheme of correlating zodiacal signs with both the limbs of the cosmos and parts of the human body gives the head of the cosmos and of man to Aries, which stands at the Midheaven. Thus the tenth house represents the pinnacle of a person's glory, achievement, and success in life. It also indicates the aspects of the self that are most manifest and visible to the public.

1 MANILIUS, *Astronomica* 2.810–820.

of adequacy. Pluto describes a struggle where the baby's head is jammed into a narrow birth canal being pushed by powerful contractions, resulting in life experienced as a titanic struggle for survival and periodic sequences of breakdown and rebirth. Uranus denotes the sudden, final liberation from constriction, with lifelong patterns of rebelliousness and breaking free from any kind of restriction.[5]

A compelling argument against the traditional doctrine that the twelfth house is a cadent place signifying weakness is presented by the studies on the Gauquelin sectors. Research studies have found that planets in a zone approximately ten to twenty degrees above the Ascendant, which in quadrant house systems places them in the twelfth house, are statistically significant as indicators of professional achievement in accordance with the nature of each planet. In terms of timing, these planets would have risen over the Ascendant approximately one to two hours prior to birth, which is the general interval marking the beginning of the transition stage of labor. This has led me to wonder if a planet crossing the Ascendant when the fetus begins it journey from the uterus into the birth canal also leaves an indelible mark upon the character of the native, which is depicted in the birth chart as a twelfth-house planet.

From the Hellenistic through to the modern periods, the most basic and enduring meaning of the twelfth house was enemies. This core topic arises from the notion of the Bad Spirit as a bringer of misfortune, a companion on the path of life which can lead the native astray into temptation, wrong-doing, and harm. Initially, twelfth-house enemies were outer enemies, objective others external to the native; not simply competitors, but rather those whom you feared might harm you or who actually did seek to harm you. Arabic and Medieval texts emphasize the hidden and jealous nature of these kinds of enemies. In discussions concerning the twelfth house, they give detailed procedures for judging whether a person will have few, many, or no enemies; reconciliation or antagonism with the enemy; the nature and strength of the enemy; from where the enmity arises; and who will prevail and vanquish the other. Twelfth-house enemies are not only demons and actual persons, but also other kinds of hidden matters that have the potential to cause disruption and harm, such as secrets, scandals, family skeletons, physical dysfunctions, clandestine and illegal activities, spies, traitors, and witchcraft.

In the late nineteenth century, Sigmund Freud popularized the idea of the unconscious as the hidden realm of the psyche that contains all the disturbing,

5 Stanislav GROF, *The Adventure of Self-Discovery* (New York: State University of New York Press, 1988).

is configured to Mercury by a square aspect (FIGURE 108). Should Saturn, as Mercury's domicile lord, be exalted in Libra in the favorable eleventh house of good expectations, assistance will come from esteemed friends and associates who bolster the financial picture. Even though Saturn witnesses Mercury by a superior square, Saturn is exalted in Libra in this chart and has a good house location. He can therefore function more benefically, and is not necessarily obstructive as long as the native is serious, responsible, hardworking, and pays respect to their friends or patrons. This beneficial relationship is amplified should Mercury belong to the day sect, making him a sect mate of Saturn. However, should Saturn be placed in Aries, the sign of his fall (located in the fifth house in this example, and configured to Mercury by square) the person's financial well-being may be both burdened and diminished over time due to difficulties arising from the native's children or creative endeavors. (All the more so if Saturn is of the contrary sect to Mercury).

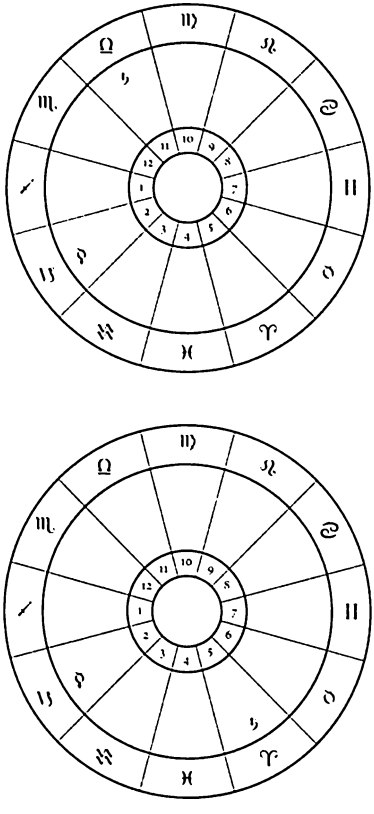


FIGURE 108. CONDITION OF THE PLANET'S DOMICILE LORD

Saturn as lord of Mercury in Capricorn (second house), exalted (above) versus fallen (below).

We have already explored the role of a planet's domicile lord in the evaluation of its condition.[2] Now we must expand that to include the importance of the lord's house location. A domicile lord that is angular has more potency to act as a benefactor to its guest planet than a lord that is cadent. A lord that lies in the sixth or twelfth house may send troubles relating to the topics of its house, such as illness or sorrows—especially if the lord itself is in poor condition and contrary to the sect of the chart.

2 Volume one, chapters 12–13.

abandoned, and deprived of his affections and attention. However, the honors accorded the children dramatically improved after his death (Jupiter also rules the eighth house), after which they became administrators of his vast estate, and artists in their own right.

MARS in Cancer in the twelfth house has the Moon in the fifth house of Sagittarius as his domicile lord. The Moon is in aversion to Mars, though they are connected due to having the same ascensional time: their significations mature and come forth around the same time.[4] The Moon does not provide Mars with the compassion, sympathy, kindness, and understanding that might temper Mars' ill treatment of others. Located in the fifth house of children, this aversion also contributed to estrangements with his children, which became increasingly disassociative as he got older.

VENUS in Libra in the third house is her own domicile lord as she rules the sign in which she is located. She is flush with her own resources and not dependent upon any other planet for support. Picasso's primary mode of communication was through his art. In his childhood education (third house), he failed miserably at his letters and numbers but excelled in art. His first word referred to the pencil he used for drawing. The artistic proficiency by which he communicated to the world continually improved over the course of his life.

In evaluating this chart as a whole, we see that four of the seven planets are in aversion to their domicile lords. This suggests a pattern of insecurity in the support one can expect from others and can lead to either fears of abandonment or excessive self-reliance as compensatory behaviors. It may be observed that many of Picasso's paintings were of blind people. This could be an expression of all the "blind spots" or aversions in his own psyche, as indicated in his chart. The Sun, Mercury, and Saturn do not have any responsibilities, met or unmet, to other planets. Venus alone has a stable and plentiful supply of resources, which are her own.

→ EXERCISE 43

Using your own chart, complete exercise 43:
A Planet's Assistance from its Domicile Lord

4 See volume 1, chapter 53, table 24.

be the cause of illness, prison, enemies, or exile, etc. If, on the other hand, the ruler of the twelfth house is in the tenth house, then enemies, prisons, and exiles will be the cause of honor, recognition, and professional activities.[2] In the first case, tenth-house professional activities gravitate towards twelfth-house afflictions, while in the second case, twelfth-house afflictions become the substance of tenth-house public recognition. It is the lord's nature and condition that contribute to the relative good or ill quality that influences the outcome of the house under consideration.

In a similar manner, the house placement of the lord of each house shows the natural direction towards which the activities of that house flow. The second-house topics center around finances. If the lord of the second house is in the fifth, the finances flow towards children or creative endeavors; if in the seventh, towards the partner; if in the eleventh, towards friends; if in the ninth, towards religion, higher education, or travel. These people or topics play a prominent role in the financial affairs of the native.

Seventh-house topics center upon marriage. If the lord of the seventh is in the fifth, the natural impulse of the native's relationship needs is directed towards children, creative partnerships, or romance; if in the fourth, towards ownership of a home, land, and participation in family life; if in the ninth, marriage to a foreigner or partnership centered around religious or spiritual beliefs. The house of the lord points to the place where committed relationships eventually land, for better or worse.

This guideline is especially important in the analysis of the lord of the Ascendant, which was regarded later in the tradition as the ruler of the entire chart. Its house placement shows the focus and direction of the life force, the kinds of activities that steer the person towards their destiny. If the lord of the first house is in the second house, finances and livelihood become the guiding direction of the life journey; in the third house, siblings or communications; in the fourth house, home and parents; in the fifth house, children; and so on.[3]

The house location of the lord shows not only the direction towards which the topics of a house gravitate, but also the types of topics that the lord can offer to the house it rules. We have previously discussed how a planet must use the topics of the house in which it resides to carry forth its agenda, regardless of whether they are easy or difficult. These are also the kinds of topics that it has to offer to the planets in its domiciles as well as to the houses it rules. On the most basic interpretive level, if the lord of a house is itself located in a fortunate house,

2 MORINUS, *Astrologica Gallica* 21.2.5.

3 See chapter 87 for a more complete discussion of the ruler of the Ascendant.

means "to stand under" or "to support", and indicates the underlying reality behind something that supports everything else, or which forms a firm foundation upon which we can have confidence. In Stoic philosophy, which permeated much of Valens' view, *hupostasis* was also used in the sense of concrete, objective reality, analogous to the Latin word *substantia*, the "substance" of matter itself. In an astrological context, Valens seems to be addressing the factors that provide the underlying concrete support system of the chart, and to what extent there exists a stable foundation upon which an individual life can flourish.

Valens uses the Greek word *eudaimonia* to describe the condition of well-being that rests upon this foundation. Etymologically, it consists of the words *eu*, "good" and *daimōn*, "spirit", and means to have a "good spirit" as one's support system. Schmidt translated *eudaimonia* as "happiness" while Riley chose "good fortune". Both are primary meanings as given in the Greek lexicon. However, *eudaimonia*, like *hupostasis*, was a complex philosophical term in antiquity subject to much disagreement. The notion of happiness was not merely an emotional state based upon pleasure and gratification, but a term used for the highest human good, and included virtue or excellence of character. Some philosophers such as Aristotle acknowledged the importance of health, wealth, and beauty as part of *eudaimonia*, while others such as the Stoics made virtue alone necessary for a good life. For Neoplatonists such as Plotinus, union with the divine mind (*nous*), the source of being itself, was the ultimate source of well-being.

In practical terms, the rulers of the Ascendant, Fortune, and the luminaries, as articulated in the astrological texts, are responsible for providing general happiness, good fortune, success, prosperity, assets, substance, reputation, and eminence: qualities that characterize a flourishing and thriving life. In the Dorotheus text, this state of well-being is described as good fortune, assets, and wealth.[3] This suggests the practical concerns of ancient astrologers and their clients. However, the use of these terms also points to a hidden spiritual and philosophical code that can be employed and which may have been recognized by initiates.

These broader qualities, which support the substantiality of the life as a whole, come under the jurisdiction of planets that rule particular power concentrations in each individual chart. The planets in question—the domicile lord of the Ascendant, the domicile lord of the Lot of Fortune, and the triplicity lords of the sect light (Sun or the Moon according to sect)—are invested with the power of a ruler in regards to the nativity. They speak to the support system that facilitates the "actualization of the soul".

3 DOROTHEUS, *Carmen Astrologicum* 1.26.

In book two of the *Anthology*, Valens emphasizes the preeminent roles attributed to the domicile lord of the Ascendant (as well as to the lord of Fortune and to the triplicity lords of the sect light). He gives extensive delineations for the planet that is "allotted the Hour or the Lot" when it occupies each of the twelve houses. Valens explains how the judgment of a planet is modified by the positive or negative testimony it receives from each of the other planets.[1]

> When the Sun is alloted the Hour or Fortune while it marks the hour: if Jupiter is also co-present or should witness by square, the native will be fortunate. If Mercury is co-present with it, he will advance through words. If Mars should be co-present or square along with Jupiter, he will be great and will have authority over life and death. And if, while these things are so, if Saturn should be square or opposite, they will fall into mishaps or dangers.[2]

In book seven, Valens set out the teachings concerning the evaluation of the domicile lord of the Ascendant for both the "vital times", which refers to length of life, as well as for the "actualization of the soul", which suggests the potency of the native to direct a successful life journey.

He gave the following criteria by which to assess the domicile lord of the Ascendant. The best placement for the lord of the Ascendant was to be located in the first house itself or in another zodiacal sign of its rulership. This probably refers to its other domicile sign, but can also be extended to its exaltation or triplicity sign as well. Factors that may weaken or restrict the successful outcomes initiated by the lord of the Ascendant are when it is setting (under the Descendant), or occupying the signs of its detriment, fall, or contrary sect, because its vitality and potency become exhausted at the conclusion of certain time-lord periods.[3]

This chapter will focus upon understanding the nature of the lord of the Ascendant and evaluating its capacity to be effective. At the end, there will be a few remarks concerning how it was used in the evaluation of the vital times.

1 VALENS, *Anthology* 2.4–15.
2 VALENS, *Anthology* 2.4.
3 VALENS, *Anthology* 7.2.

CHAPTER 88

Introducing Lots

THE LOT OF FORTUNE AND THE LORD OF FORTUNE

TRADITIONAL ASTROLOGY INCLUDES THE USE OF MANY LOTS (*KLĒROI*), which are often referred to as the Arabic Parts in contemporary astrology. Lots are sensitive points in a chart that were used to give additional information on a vast range of specific topics, such as the Lot of Children, the Lot of Marriage, the Lot of Siblings, the Lot of Injury, the Lot of Accusation, the Lot of Death, the Lot of Adultery, the Lot of Farming, the Lot of Sailing, and the Lot of Enemies. Each Lot is derived mathematically from the distances between two planets or points in a chart, giving an arc of separation that is then projected from the Ascendant. The first and most important Lots originated from the earliest stratum of Hellenistic astrology, and were attributed to the legendary divinity, Hermes Trismegistus. Over time, Arabic and Medieval astrologers added many more Lots to the corpus. In the ninth century, Abū Ma'shar listed ninety-seven Lots that he found in the texts of the ancient astrologers from Persia, Babylonia, Egypt, and the Greeks.[1]

The Lot of Fortune (or Part of Fortune) is the most important of all the Lots. It indicates the relative fortune of wealth, material acquisitions, and well-being that a person might expect in life. It is often interpreted along with its domicile lord, the planet that rules the zodiacal sign in which it is located. The Lot and its lord were given great prominence and power in the overall assessment of the life as a whole. The domicile lord of Fortune was treated as equal in power to the lord of the Ascendant by Valens. This planet holds a global role in governing a person's life in terms of their overall prosperity and physical health. Before we discuss the lord of Fortune as a ruler of the nativity, we will first provide some background on what a Lot is, how it is derived, and how it is used.

1 ABŪ MA'SHAR and other Arabic astrologers may well have had access to an extensive listing of the Lots contained in *A Commentary on Paulus Alexandrinus* written by Olympiodorus as a series of lectures given in Alexandria from May to July of 564 CE. For English translations, see James H. HOLDEN and Dorian G. GREENBAUM.

SIGN RULERSHIPS

The second consideration in the evaluation of the triplicity lords is the zodiacal signs which they occupy. A triplicity lord which has power deriving from the rulership of its sign indicates brilliance and eminence. A planet in its own domicile or exaltation naturally gives power and esteem to the individual. However, it is especially noteworthy if a triplicity lord is its own triplicity ruler, or is at least in the same zodiacal triplicity in which it has some rulership. The Medieval astrologers said a planet in its own triplicity is like a man who is among his allies and people, who obey and follow him.[15] The triplicity lord benefits from the assistance and support provided by others. In contemporary parlance relative to social media, one could say a person has many "followers" or "likes". One could also suggest that they have a strong wind at their back pushing them along rapidly towards prominence.

In the following example of a notable nativity, which Valens himself provides, you can see how he incorporates the criteria of zodiacal sign rulerships and sect status in his analysis (FIGURE 117). The chart is dated to October 25, 50 CE, at around 4.00 AM, by Neugebauer.

> Let the Sun be in Scorpio, the Moon in Cancer, Saturn in Aquarius, Jupiter in Sagittarius, Mars in Scorpio, Venus in Libra, Mercury in Scorpio, Ascendant in Libra. Since the nativity is by night, I seek the Moon. This happens to be in Cancer, in the triplicity of Mars. We found Mars rising up [towards the Ascendant] in its own domicile and triplicity and its own sect; then the one sharing in this [triplicity], Venus, in the Ascendant in her own domicile; third, the Moon culminating at the Midheaven in her own domicile. It is clear that the nativity is of high repute since the rulers are positioned suitably.
>
> Seeking the Lot of Fortune, I find it in Aquarius. Saturn, its lord, is in this [sign] in [the house of] Good Fortune in its own domicile and triplicity. The eleventh sign from the Lot of Fortune is the Place of Acquisitions. Jupiter is there. I also found the [Lot of] Exaltation of the nativity, from the Moon to Taurus, is eleven signs, and an equal amount from the Libra Ascendant. It left off in Leo in the [house of] Good Spirit. The lord of this sign, the Sun, was found in the culminating place from the Lot of Fortune. It made the nativity even more well known and held in high esteem.[16]

15 BONATTI, *Book of Astronomy* 2.2.19.
16 VALENS, *Anthology* 2.22.

the key planets, and the key points are favorably configured, the more harmoniously they can work together to achieve flourishing excellence in the life of the native. These favorable configurations provide support to the native through illumination, recognition, and material substance.

COMPARING THE TWO TRIPLICITY LORDS

In evaluating the two triplicity lords of the sect light, one may be better situated than the other. Valens explains that if the first triplicity lord is badly situated, but the second is strong by house and condition, then the person will have ups and downs in the first part of life, but will be vigorous and more effective later (except for ongoing anxiety about the return of instability). But if the principal triplicity lord is well placed, but the secondary one is badly situated, after having been carried well during the first part of life, the native's circumstances will be reduced in the second part of life. If both triplicity lords are well placed and in good condition, the circumstances of good fortune and eminence will persist throughout the life and the native will become estimable (unless a malefic planet opposes or holds a superior square to one of the triplicity lords). In every case, a triplicity lord of the sect light located in a declining cadent house becomes an obstacle to reputation, eminence, and livelihood. And all of these indications are subject to counteraction depending upon each triplicity lord's own domicile lord.[19] A benefic domicile lord in good condition, favorable location, and with positive witnessing can offset some of the weak or difficult indications of a poorly-placed triplicity lord. In the following example from Valens (FIGURE 118), we see the contrast between the different conditions of the first and second triplicity lords:

> Sun, Mars, Venus, Mercury in Aquarius, Moon and Jupiter in Scorpio, Saturn in Aries, Leo Ascendant. This nativity was reversed from a lowly and moderate fortune into an authoritative and powerful man. The nativity is diurnal: we found the Sun in the triplicity of Saturn and Saturn declining (whence the first part of life was moderate), but Mercury, the star sharing [the triplicity], to be angular. In addition, we found the Lot of Fortune in Taurus and the Lot of Exaltation in Libra; the lady [Venus] culminating in the tenth place from the Lot of Fortune, and also angular.[20]

19 VALENS, *Anthology* 2.2.
20 VALENS, *Anthology* 2.22.

micile lord of the zodiacal sign following that of the natal Moon (but skipping over Cancer and Leo), because in his opinion the Sun and Moon could never be the *Oikodespotēs*. The example that Firmicus gave to determine the *Oikodespotēs* of the entire chart is that of a person born with the Moon in Gemini. It is necessary to skip over Cancer and Leo, and then land upon Virgo, which would make Mercury—the domicile lord of Virgo—the ruler of the nativity.[15] Firmicus was clear that the Sun or Moon could never be the ruler of the nativity. However, he did allow the lights to influence the character and physical appearance of the native if the lights were co-present with the ruler, if they witnessed it with a favorable aspect, or if the ruler was the domicile or bound lord of the light.[16]

Ptolemy had a complex method for the determination of the Predominator, which he used as a starting point for calculating the length of life. However, he did not seek a single *Oikodespotēs* from the Predominator. He stated that there was not one single planet that had dominion over the many contradictory fortunate and unfortunate experiences that might occur during the same period of time, but rather many ruling planets that each governed specific topics.

He presented a method of releasing from the Ascendant for events relating to the body and journeys abroad; from the Lot of Fortune for matters of property; from the Moon for affections of the soul and for marriage; from the Sun for dignities and glory; and from the Midheaven for other matters such as actions, friendships, and the begetting of children.[17]

THE GLOBAL ROLE OF THE OIKODESPOTĒS

In a discussion concerning the scope of the *Oikodespotēs* and whether or not it was possible for one star, even though it is an *Oikodespotēs*, to give uniformly good or bad fortune on all topics throughout the life, Valens included a passage from Petosiris, whom he said had obscured it mysteriously:

> Beginning, end, dominion over all the places under examination—the star according to each nativity that is the *Oikodespotēs*, which makes clear beforehand for the children which ones will have life and what kind of support they will have for it, what kind of character they will have and the form of their body, all of this follows from this star. And without this star, there is nothing, neither action nor reputation, that exists for anyone.[18]

15 FIRMICUS, *Mathesis* 4.6.
16 FIRMICUS, *Mathesis* 4.8.31–40.
17 PTOLEMY, *Tetrabiblos* 4.10.
18 *Anthology* 2.41.3–4.

The *Oikodespotēs* has two clear-cut roles as the Master of the Nativity. The first is denoting the years of life, which we will discuss in the final chapters. The second is the shaping of the character, constitution, and appearance of the individual. The Hellenistic astrologers acknowledged the intimate connection between the *Oikodespotēs* and the bound lords. Indeed, this seems to be the major application of the bound lord rulership system. The cumulative zodiacal bound lord degrees of each planet determined the greater years ascribed to that planet, and formed the starting point for length-of-life determinations.

Porphyry designated the bound lord of the Predominator as the Joint-Master (*Sunoikodespotēs*), and acknowledged several traditions where the bound lord of the Ascendant was the *Oikodespotēs*. Valens looked to the bound lord of the Predominator for the office of *Oikodespotēs*. Dorotheus looked first to the bound lord of the Predominator to confirm the Predominator's authority to release the times of life, before considering other options. Paulus included the bound lord in his assessment concerning which of the Predominator's lords was most qualified for the rulership of the nativity, and then looked to its greater years (which were derived from the bound lords) for determining the number of years of life. Firmicus Maternus, like Paulus, looked to the *Oikodespotēs'* greater years for the indication of the years of life. Ptolemy gave second place to the bound lords of the many ruling planets (*oikodespotai*) that governed the fortunate and unfortunate events of life in accordance with their specific topics.

The most comprehensive character delineations for the Master of the Nativity are contained in Firmicus Maternus and Rhetorius.[19] Because neither the Sun nor Moon are given descriptions as rulers or lords of the nativity, we must assume that both authors were following the tradition of considering only the five planets that are bound lords to identify the Master of the Nativity. These descriptions articulate the qualities of a person's character, their professional indications, as well as their physical constitution and bodily illnesses.

Here are two examples. The first, from Teucer of Babylon, is when Jupiter assumes the role of the Master of the Nativity:

> When Jupiter receives the rulership [*Oikodespotēs*] of the nativity upon an angle by day and operates in its own domicile or that of a sect mate, it indicates important and notable persons, acceptable, revered, good, open-hearted, high-minded, those who accomplish matters beyond the power of cities or the common people, those who are received by kings and other great people, well-spoken because of their virtue and piety, those who prepare honors of sacred offerings, affec-

19 FIRMICUS, *Mathesis* 4.6–8, trans. HOLDEN; RHETORIUS, *Compendium*, excerpt from TEUCER OF BABYLON.

> tionate towards family and beneficent to friends, and who delight in their wives and children, unless Jupiter occurs upon the setting angle, for then they are not blessed with children in this way.
>
> If Jupiter is greatly damaged by destructive stars striking its beneficence, in a manner similar to others, they have much less power for generosity and their advancements will be regarded with jealousy. And Jupiter itself has similar significations in accordance with itself; whatever configurations it makes with other stars will be said in what follows.
>
> And it makes white-skinned persons, plump, full-bearded, good manners, dignified, large, broad-browed, bright-eyed, hair in the nostrils, bald, a large head, giving good counsel. This person will die from a sore throat, pneumonia, headache, heart conditions, apoplexy, and those conditions that arise from an excess of wind.[20]

The second, from Firmicus Maternus, describes Mars. Note the descriptions of the character traits and the physical body and its aliments:

> If Mars is made the Ruler [*Oikodespotēs*] of the Nativity, it will make rugged, invincible persons, and those who cannot be subjugated by any means, excitable, contentious persons, daring, prone to dangers, violent persons, who are accustomed to be deceived in frequent ways, gluttonous persons who digest much food in the easiest way, strong, equable, vehement.
>
> And persons with red hair, bloodshot eyes, imperious, and always claiming the principal insignia of power for themselves. They are always practicing arts involving fire and hot iron, but they are preposterous in their hot temper. And they do not have affection for their wife, or their children, or their friends. They are daring and those who crave other people's possessions with an envious desire. But it will make bodily defects from fire and iron, i.e., from cuts and burning; and he frequently falls down from the highest places or breaks his extremities; but it will make his death to be either sudden or violent.[21]

20 *On the Nature of the Planets* (from TEUCER OF BABYLON as transmitted by RHETORIUS), CCAG 7, p. 216.

21 FIRMICUS, *Mathesis* 4.7.13, trans. HOLDEN.

of ninth-century Baghdad. It eventually found its way back into Europe through astro-magical works such as the *Picatrix* (thirteenth century), Marsilio Ficino's *Three Books on Life* (fifteenth century), and Heinrich Cornelius Agrippa's *Three Books of Occult Philosophy* (sixteenth century). Knowledge of one's personal planetary deity remained a secret key to religious contemplation, esoteric practice, and magical rites that aspired towards the liberation of the soul.

PROCEDURE FOR DETERMINING THE KURIOS

The requirements for determining the *Kurios* were more stringent and numerous than for the *Oikodespotēs*.[16] While the search for the *Oikodespotēs* according to Porphyry focused primarily upon the strength of the two lights, the angularity of their house locations, and their eastern ascension, the identification of the *Kurios* considered additional criteria such as visibility, zodiacal rulerships, and witnessing from other planets. These are the same factors that Paulus and Ptolemy included in their lists of criteria for the selection of a single *Oikodespotēs* or for other important ruling planets. However for Porphyry, all of the planets were possible candidates. Porphyry set forth two different methods for arriving at the planetary Lord:

> On one hand, some define the Lord of the Nativity as the ruler of the Midheaven, if it is operative upon an angular house, or if not, then a planet that is present upon the Midheaven ruling as a monarch over the actions of the nativity as if upon a citadel, and if not, a planet ascending towards the Midheaven.
>
> Others define the Lord of the Nativity as first, the lord of the Ascendant or a planet that has stepped onto the Ascendant in its domicile and bounds, then the lord of the Moon, then the lord of the Midheaven, then the lord of Fortune, then a planet making a phase of rising or setting or station seven days before or within seven days of the birth. For this planet is authoritative as it conforms to the cosmic state and to those being born at that time; if there are two [such planets], they reckon the one rising to be more powerful. To these they add the ruler of the prenatal lunar conjunction; I mean the ruler of the bounds in which the conjunction of the Moon to the Sun occurred if the Moon was being borne away from the conjunction [i.e., New Moon]; but if the Moon is waning, the ruler of the bounds of the Full Moon.[17]

16 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 30.
17 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 30.

Table 91. The Seven Candidates for the Kurios, Chart One

1. *Lord of the Ascendant:* MARS

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Eastern hemisphere (eleventh house) Evening-rising visibility
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: none (0) Domicile and exaltation of non-sect mate, Mercury Triplicity and bounds of sect mate, Venus
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Succedent Eleventh house (third-best)
WITNESSING	Mercury (domicile and exaltation lord) in aversion Superior square from Venus (benefic, triplicity/bound lord) Superior square from Jupiter (benefic) Inferior square from Saturn (malefic) Enclosed by rays of benefics

2. *Planet in the domicile and bounds of the Ascendant:* NONE

3. *Lord of the Moon:* MARS

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Eastern hemisphere (eleventh house) Evening-rising visibility
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: none (0) Domicile and exaltation of non-sect mate, Mercury Triplicity and bounds of sect mate, Venus
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Succedent Eleventh house (third-best)
WITNESSING	Mercury (domicile and exaltation lord) in aversion Superior square from Venus (benefic, triplicity/bound lord) Superior square from Jupiter (benefic) Inferior square from Saturn (malefic) Enclosed by rays of benefics

4. Lord of the Midheaven: SUN

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Eastern hemisphere (tenth house) (Sun is the point of reference for visibility)
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: (2) domicile and triplicity lord Bounds of Jupiter
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Angular tenth house
WITNESSING	Superior sextile from Jupiter (benefic, bound lord) Witnesses itself as own triplicity lord Superior sextile from Venus (benefic)

5. Lord of the Lot of Fortune: SUN

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Eastern hemisphere (tenth house) (Sun is the point of reference for visibility)
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: (2) domicile and triplicity lord Bounds of Jupiter
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Angular tenth house
WITNESSING	Superior sextile from Jupiter (benefic, bound lord) Witnesses itself as own triplicity lord Superior sextile from Venus (benefic)

6. Heliacal rising, set, station within seven days: NONE

Table 92. The Seven Candidates for the Kurios, Chart Two

1. Lord of the Ascendant: SUN

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Western hemisphere (fourth house) (Sun is reference point for visibility)
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: none (0) Domicile, triplicity, and bounds of Mars (witnesses by trine)
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Angular fourth house
WITNESSING	Opposition from Saturn (malefic)

2. Planet in the domicile and bounds of the Ascendant: NONE

3. Lord of the Moon: JUPITER

EASTERN HEMISPHERE OR MORNING VISIBILITY	Eastern hemisphere Acronychal phase
ZODIACAL RULERSHIPS	Own places: none (0) Domicile of Venus; triplicity of the Moon; bounds of Saturn
RELATIVE ANGULARITY	Angular tenth house
WITNESSING	Co-presence with Saturn (bound lord) Aversion to domicile lord, Venus (benefic), shares sympathy Aversion to triplicity lord, the Moon

The term "releaser" (in some translations, the "prorogator" or "controller") comes from the Greek word *aphetēs*, which was translated into Arabic as *hīlāj* and transmitted into Latin as *hyleg*. The notion of the releaser is comparable to a charioteer being released from the starting gate (*husplēx*) in order to enter the course of the chariot race (*harmatodromia*). In an astrological context, the releaser is the life force itself which is released at birth to run the course of the lifespan, from the "starting gate" to the "finish line", whereupon the releaser exhausts its allotment of life force.

Timing techniques that look to a releaser entail the movement of the planets and points around the chart after the native's birth. The basic structure of time-lord procedures based upon a releaser may be understood in terms of the following three components:

1. THE RELEASER (LIFE FORCE)
   A point or planet which "moves" through the degrees of the chart. The releaser represents the native or the life force itself.
2. THE JOURNEY OF THE RELEASER (LIFE COURSE)
   The arc or trajectory of the releaser through the chart, representing the course of the life's journey.
3. CONDITIONS ON THE JOURNEY (LIFE PHASES)
   The arc of the releaser's journey was subject to different planetary conditions via the influence of aspect rays, or specific subdivisions of the chart. These determined the different phases of and influences upon the native's life, including those that could end the life.

Timing methods that looked to the trajectory of the releaser and which charted its critical conditions, such as times of danger, included *primary directions* (using the timing increment of 1 degree = 1 year)[2] and *circumambulations through the bounds* (using the ascensional times of the signs).

THE MASTER OF THE NATIVITY

As we saw in chapter 93, the Master of the Nativity was most often appointed by the Predominator. In the context of length-of-life procedures, the Master was referred to as the "giver of life" (*dator vitæ*) because it indicated the number of

2 With variations according to proportional semi-arcs, latitude, and longitude, as noted in the previous chapter.